

Radio Shack®

A Division of Tandy Corporation

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News Release

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What? See*

THE NEW TANDY PDA: AS EASY AS PEN AND PAPER Personal Digital Assistant Now Shipping To Radio Shack Stores Nationwide

Fort Worth, Texas -- The eagerly awaited and much anticipated Tandy® PDA Zoomer Personal Digital Assistant is now shipping to participating Radio Shack® stores nationwide.

Designed for the mass consumer market, the Tandy PDA is one of the first products in a new category of handheld devices called personal digital assistants. Pocket-sized and weighing less than one pound, the Tandy PDA is as simple to use as pen and paper yet it has the power of a personal computer plus the mobility and battery life of an electronic data organizer.

The Tandy PDA can be used to manage personal and business information -- electronically -- but using a pen instead of a miniature keyboard. The Tandy PDA has the ability to save handwritten notes or drawings, exactly as they are written or drawn with the pen. This feature, called PowerInk™ or electronic ink, is the fastest and most convenient way to store information and is particularly useful when entering large amounts of data. For smaller entries, the Tandy PDA's PalmPrint™ software has the ability to translate handwriting into text or data can be entered using one of several pop-up, on-screen keyboard choices. The GEOS® system software's easy-to-follow icons and menus make the Zoomer's power easy to use.

The Tandy PDA also has the ability to communicate -- with another Tandy PDA, with a desktop PC, with online services, and with the world. Data can be downloaded from a desktop computer through a serial port, using an optional software package. Data can also be shared with another Tandy PDA through the wireless infrared port (approximately 5 inches). Using the America Online® information service with an optional modem and cable, users can send and receive electronic mail, send faxes, monitor the latest news and stock quotes, and book airline reservations through the EAASY SABRESM Travel Service, and more.

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Unlike its competitors, the Tandy PDA has an abundance of smart and useful applications -- more than 15 different built-in applications including Pocket Quicken™ personal finance software. Other applications include:

- ☐ **Organization:** Palm Organizer software with Notebook, Date Book/Calendar with To-Do List Manager and alarm, Address Book, and World-Time Clock.
- ☐ **Calculation:** A full-function on-screen calculator and a form calculator which includes 19 different "forms" for currency/measurement conversions, loan calculations and more.
- ☐ **Information:** A 50,000-word dictionary, 100,000-word spell checker, 660,000-word thesaurus, and a language translator to translate words in 26 different languages. Valuable information for travelers includes both U.S. and international dialing codes, airport codes, a nutrition guide, and more.
- ☐ **Communication:** Access to America Online, using an optional modem and cable. Connectivity to a PC with optional cable and PC software.
- ☐ **Recreation:** Challenging games of strategy and chance, including two solitaire card games and UKI.

New software applications, available soon, can be used by plugging them into the industry standard PCMCIA (Personal Computer Memory Card International Association) slot. Additional memory including SunDisk FlashDisk cards up to 20MB and other enhancements such as Motorola's EMBARCSM nationwide data paging service can also be added.

The Tandy PDA requires only three standard "AA" alkaline batteries (included) to operate for up to 100 hours. Information saved in the Tandy PDA is protected from the loss of battery power by two built-in lithium batteries.

The Tandy PDA sells for \$699 at participating Radio Shack stores and dealers nationwide. A one-year warranty is standard and service and support are provided by Radio Shack.

Radio Shack is the largest retailer of consumer electronics and personal computers in the United States with nearly 6,700 outlets nationwide.

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